

User 1

Has changing work shifts and wants to know spendable money before Friday.

Interview note:
"My work shifts change each week, so I want to know how much money I can spend before Friday."



User 2

Forgets bill dates and wants an early reminder.

Interview note:
"I often forget when my bills are due, so an early reminder would be really helpful."

What would make this budgeting app useful to different users?

Budgeting App Features

- Manual entry
- Weekly view
- Bill reminders
- No bank linking
- Price: not set

What problem are we solving?

3 hours: 50-minute lesson, 10-minute break, 50-minute guided practice, 10-minute break, 50-minute applied practice, and 10-minute wrap-up.

SITUATION

The problem

A team is making a budgeting app but does not know what different potential users need or what might stop them from trying it. Profiles based only on age or stereotypes can produce generic messages.

TARGET

Learning goal

Use short interview evidence to build two distinct, testable customer profiles and write one relevant message for each.

Practice material: Use the practice material supplied in the session Markdown.

Use these supplied facts

Do not replace missing information with guesses.

CASE MATERIAL

Product facts

- Fictional app features are manual expense entry, a weekly spending view, and bill reminders. Bank linking is not available. The price has not been set.

CASE MATERIAL

Fictional interview notes

- "My work shifts change each week. I want to know how much I can spend before Friday."
- "I already use a spreadsheet. I would switch only if tracking takes less time."
- "I forget bill dates even when I have enough money. A reminder a few days early would help."
- "I do not want a new app to connect to my bank account."

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Build profiles from what people actually said

- Start with an observed situation and a stated need. One note says work shifts change and the person wants to know what can be spent before Friday. Another says bill dates are forgotten and an early reminder would help. These are different needs. Do not add age, income, family status, or personality traits that are not in the notes.

LEARN

Separate a user need from a product claim

- A job to be done describes progress a person wants in a situation. A barrier explains what makes that progress difficult. The available app facts are manual entry, a weekly view, and bill reminders. Bank linking is not available and price is unset, so a profile or message must not claim either feature.

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Check whether each message is relevant and supportable

- Connect one stated need to an available feature. Do not claim guaranteed savings or imply that a few interviewees represent a whole market. Add one unanswered question to each profile, such as what tracking takes today or when a reminder is useful. Those questions guide the next interview instead of being filled with guesses.

APPLY

Three-step method

- Identify what each person wants and what makes it difficult; group notes with similar needs while preserving differences; draft a message and check it against product facts and source notes.

What makes a prompt weak?

These examples come from the current session scenario.

POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Create two customer personas for our budgeting app.

Message AI...

POOR PROMPT 2 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Make both personas excited to buy and write persuasive ads.

Message AI...

A clearer, safer prompt

Keep the source, task, constraints, and output check visible.

IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Use only the four fictional interview notes and product facts below.
Create two profiles based on different stated needs. For each, include the goal,
exact supporting note, barrier, and one unanswered question.
Do not infer age, income, or willingness to pay.

Message AI...

IMPROVED PROMPT 2 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Write one short message for each profile using only available app features.
Address the stated need. Do not claim bank linking or guaranteed savings.
Label any untested claim as a hypothesis.

Message AI...

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

- Paste the product facts and notes into AI. Run Improved Prompt 1. Check that every need points to a supplied note. Change unsupported details to unanswered questions.

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

APPLIED PRACTICE

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

- Run Improved Prompt 2. Pair each message with its supporting note. Ask a classmate which message feels relevant and what remains unclear. Revise one sentence without adding unavailable features.

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W8_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- Introduction: Describe the budgeting app and why profiles based only on age or stereotypes are not useful.
- Method: Copy Improved Prompts 1 and 2 and the sentence you revised.
- Results: Include the two profiles with each need paired with its source note, and the two messages.
- Conclusion: Name one untested assumption for each profile, and what your classmate found relevant or unclear.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- Each profile is supported by a note, and neither message promises an unavailable feature or proven outcome.